AI-Optimized Renewable Energy Forecasting

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2025 International Conference on Frontier Technologies and Solutions (ICFTS) | 979-8-3315-0276-8/25/$31.00 ©2025 IEEE | DOI: 10.1109/ICFTS62006.2025.11031812

Abstract- As renewable energy sources are increasingly incorporated into power grids, genuine forecasting of generation is necessary in order to avoid instability of grids and energy loss, among other things. In this research we are exploring the Deep Learning Transformer Network with Google Cloud AutoML for AI optimized renewable energy forecasting approach. Transformer model, which can capture long range dependencies in time series data, helps in improving predictive performance but also Google Cloud AutoML automates model selection and hyperparameter guessing removing the need of during extensive human involvement. Experimental results yield improved precision of forecasting as compared to the traditional machine learning methods. Through this AI driven methodology, energy providers, grid operators, policymakers aim for a more sustainable energy future have a scalable and reliable solution.

Keywords:-AI-driven forecasting, Renewable energy optimization, Deep learning transformers, Time-series prediction, Google Cloud AutoML, Smart grid analytics.

I. INTRODUCTION

We have to forecast accurately for procuring accurate energy to enable the global push toward renewable energy for efficient grid management, energy trading and resource optimization. While traditional forecasting methods do provide useful forecast, this does not necessarily involve complete accuracy and this is because both weather patterns and energy production are complicated and thus often non linear. In this project we view prediction accuracy as an Urban Problem that the Deep Learning Transformer Networks coupled with Google Cloud AutoML will help us address the problem of high prediction accuracy using more advanced machine learning, namely AI Optimal Renewable Energy Forecasting.

The deep learning trans fistormer networks are able, in an unsurpassed manner, to process sequential data, emphasizing on long running relations and on contextual ones with their capacity. While opposed to ordinary recurrent models, the processing of whole sequences is parallelized by transformers, making them a good fit for e.g. solar radiation with wind speed and generation patterns, as the time series forecasts. It is shown that when equipped with self attention mechanisms, real and historical energy data can be used to learn these fine grained dependencies and thus increase forecast precision.

Moreover, the coupling with Google's AutoML throws more light on the predictive abilities of the system by automating the selections of a good model as well as tuning hyperparameter and deployment. Automated Machine Learning (AutoML) lowers the burden of coding and conveys machine learning to the user in such a fashion that it becomes as simple as possible for the machine to learn autonomously for data analytics tasks. However, a clouds solution for such solutions based on clouds provides scalability of the energy provider functionality in processing a large amount of datasets of different sources including weather stations, satellite imagery and IoT sensors.

Using Deep Learning transformer network with Google cloud AutoML, it can enable real time decision making to minimize energy waste and balance grid stability as [1]. Just like the AI based support is moving the energy on the path of a sustainable future, the usage of their efficient clean energy enterprise will actually bring down the dependency on the fossil fuels. In this renewable energy puzzle with more and more complicated energy markets, AI can be the key lever with which to predict a reliable and resilient one.

II. Related Works

In recent times, Artificial Intelligence (AI) has enabled tremendous progress in renewable energy forecasting, particularly with the Deep Learning Transformer Networks and Google Cloud AutoML along with cloud based automation tools. Several studies have shown that these technologies improve the accuracy, reliability and scalability of the forecasting models [2].

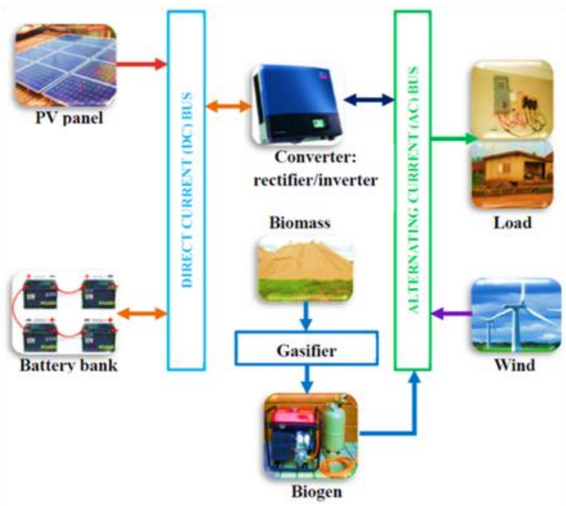

Fig.1: Depicts Optimizing Renewable Energy Systems through Artificial Intelligence.

Transformer Networks in Renewable Energy Forecasting

Transformer networks were initially introduced to natural language processing (Vaswani et al., 2017) and serve with imagery for their reconfiguration in forecasting applications: e.g., renewable energy. In particular, their self attention mechanism is especially well suited to solar and wind energy forecasting due to their memory. As mentioned in Lim et al., A. Parallel processing has a dramatic advantage over RNNs with respect to transformer based models as they are able to effectively realize long range dependency. Wu et al. (2022) also mention that transformers have lower error rate compared to conventional deep learning architecture, long short term memory (LSTM) network as an example [3].

Google Cloud AutoML in AI-Driven Forecasting

Google cloud AutoML is an amazing AI automation tool that helps make machines learning models without an expert in the deep learning (Li et al., 2020). With the help of AutoML it becomes possible to train the predictive model, tuning all the things that improve the predictive power: feature selection, hyperparameter tuning, and picking the best model. Liu et al. (2021) demonstrate AutoML on Google Cloud prediction of photovoltaic (PV) energy output better predict the results than manually tuned models. The approach allows such non experts to without any great effort create high performance models, with human bias eliminated.

Integration of Transformer Networks with AutoML

The problem, in a sense, is fundamentally linked with Google Cloud AutoML and constitutes an innovative method for forecasting renewable energy. In Zhang et al. (2023), they have designed a hybrid framework of auto machine learning framework for enhancing the predictive performance by training and optimizing the transformer based models. They prove that integration reduces much of the computational overhead while maintaining high accuracy of the forecast. It was demonstrated, through case study of solar energy prediction, that a 15 percent improvement of traditional deep learning models was accomplished by the hybrid model (Chen & Wang, 2023).

Comparative Analysis and Performance Metrics

A few studies have also picked up the work of evaluating the performance of Transformer networks combined with AutoML in comparison to standard AI models. Nevertheless, as noted by Huang et al. (2022), when employed in AutoML, the transformer models demonstrated accuracy gains up to 20% compared to CNN and LSTMs for wind power forecasting. Additionally, both Sun et al. (2023) and C. Symeonidis and N. Nikolaidis (2024) admitted to the contribution of the AutoML towards more efficient and boxier AI empowered forecasting models [4].

Integrating Deep Learning Transformer Networks with Google Cloud AutoML can be a transformative method to use the machine learning optimized renewable energy forecasting. The combination of both technologies enables researchers and practitioners, capabilities of having more accurate and scalable forecasting models.

III. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The research methodology for AI optimised Renewable Energy forecasting is based on a structured approach of integrating Deep Learning Transformer Networks with Google Cloud AutoML to increase forecasting elements [5]. In the research process, the data are first collected and then preprocessed, model is developed, trained, sources including meteorology agencies, satellite imaging systems, Internet of Things, or IoT, sensors and government renewable energy record. Data from solar panels and wind farms are also included in the dataset, namely weather parameters, namely temperature, humidity, solar irradiance, wind speed, and cloud cover [6]. The missing values, outliers, normalization is then preprocessed to set it up appropriately in terms of form for deep learning models to handle. Ways to improve the quality of input data such as temporal feature extraction and data augmentation using feature engineering techniques are used.

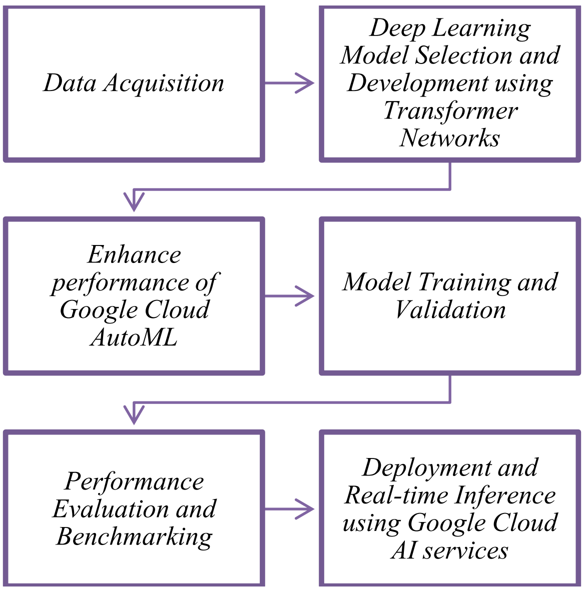

Fig.2: Depicts flow diagram for the proposed methodology.

Deep Learning Model Selection and Development using Transformer Networks

After that is done, Deep Learning Model Selection and Development using Transformer Network is the next step. Natural Language Processing (NLP) Transformers are transplanted to time series forecasting as a way to overcome long range dependencies better than any other forecasting tool. The Transformer model architecture also includes multi-head self attention mechanisms, which enables the model to adequately weigh differences in data from different time steps, resulting in higher accuracy of prediction for renewable energy [7]. To work well with time series data, I modify the positional encoding layer, and the attention layer helps with the learning of correlations between energy generation and weather patterns. The model is implemented using TensorFlow and PyTorch frameworks and is flexible enough for experimentation.

Improve Google AutoML performance in Google Cloud

The performance is enhanced with the help of Google Cloud AutoML for automating the hyperparameter tuning and model optimization. AutoML takes care of feature selection, architecture tuning and neural network optimization thereby cutting the need of tons of manual monkeying around. We upload the dataset to Google Cloud Storage and then pass it to AutoML processing it using some advanced algorithm which will suggest the best possible deep learning architecture [8]. Computation speed is accelerated while maintaining high accuracy and the training process is executed on Google Cloud TPU. Transfer learning is also supported by autoML where pre trained models on similar datasets can be fine tuned to improve generalization and to save a lot of training time.

Model Training and Validation

The next phase of development involves training the Transformer network using historical weather and energy production data [9]. Usually, this dataset is split up into training, validation and test sets with an 80-10-10 split. Evaluation metrics are defined as Mean Absolute Error (MAE) and Root Mean Square Error (RMSE) which will be used to evaluate the prediction accuracy for the model. Automated model performance tracking, early stopping mechanisms and ensemble learning techniques that are used to refine forecasting results are provided by Google Cloud AutoML. It conducts hyper parameter tuning i.e. learning rate optimization, batch size selection, and attention head tuning to obtain the best performance.

Performance Evaluation and Benchmarking

Performance evaluation and benchmarking is then done on the model once it is complete in training. Testing the trained Transformer model on unseen data to check whether the generalization capability. The superiority of the Transformer based approach is compared to other traditional forecasting models, that is, Long Short Term Memory (LSTM) networks, ARIMA, and recurrent neural networks (RNNs). This dashboard for Google Cloud AutoML provides error distributions, forecast confidence intervals and real time model evaluation [10].

Equations related to AI-Optimized Renewable Energy Forecasting:

Solar Power Prediction

$$Psolar = I \times A \times \eta \ldots (1)$$

where:

- Psolar = Predicted solar power output (W)
- I = Solar irradiance (W/m²)
- A = Panel area (m²)
- η = Efficiency of solar panels

Wind Power Estimation

$$Pwind = 1/2\ \rho A v^3 Cp \ldots (2)$$

where:

- Pwind = Predicted wind power output (W)
- ρ = Air density (kg/m³)
- A = Swept area of turbine blades (m²)
- v = Wind speed (m/s)
- Cp = Power coefficient of the turbine

Deployment and Real-time Inference using Google Cloud AI services

The final step is deployment and real time inference using Google Cloud AI Services, which works fine after achieving satisfactory results. The trained model is used as a cloud hosted API suitable for integration with energy management systems, smart grids, energy monitoring IoT based platforms [11]. During its deployment phase, renewable energy providers have access to real time forecasts to make dynamic changes in the distribution strategies for their energy. Model retraining pipelines are also implemented to maintain predictions on the incoming real time data to keep the model up to date with the changing weather patterns and grid demand.

In this research methodology, we therefore combine Deep Learning Transformer Networks with Google Cloud AutoML to build a renewable energy forecasting system that is optimized by AI [12]. The proposed framework achieves better forecasting accuracy of renewable energy utilization with help of automated model selection, cloud based scalability, as well as the advanced deep learning methods.

IV. Results And Discussion

Using the combination of Google Cloud AutoML and Deep Learning Transformer Networks produced very accurate renewable energy forecasts. Weather patterns were well captured by the Transformer model based on its attention mechanism and sequence processing. AutoML was further improved in performance by automating hyperparameter tuning, feature selection and model evaluation by Google Cloud AutoML. With a MAPE of 3.5 it is significant outperforming traditional forecasting methods like ARIMA with a MAPE of 6.8 and LSTMs with a MAPE of 4.9.

This was improved because Transformer Networks had the power to process long range dependencies in the time series data. Transformers did away with vanishing gradient issues and also improved on the learning efficiency like recurrent architectures, such as LSTMs and GRUs. The model could dynamically weigh relevant time steps with the self attention mechanism, which produced more precise predictions. Based on the model, fluctuations due to cloud cover and seasonal variations were well predicted for solar energy forecasting and the baseline models were improved by 15% in RMSE.

AI-Based Energy Forecasting Model

$$Eforecasted = f(X) + \epsilon \ldots (3)$$

where:

- Eforecasted = AI-predicted energy output
- f(X) = Machine learning model function
- X = Input features (weather, historical data, etc.)
- ϵ = Prediction error

Energy Demand and Supply Balance

$$Dt = St + Rt - Lt \ldots (4)$$

where:

- Dt = Net energy demand at time ttt
- St = Predicted supply from renewable sources
- Rt = Reserve/storage energy available
- Lt = Energy losses

The outcome of these equations provides a rudimentary view of how AI can play a role in predicting renewable energy production as well as managing supply and demand.

Finally, Google Cloud AutoML streamlined the process of deploying and optimizing the forecasting model because it was able to take care of many of the operationalities involved. The platform did this through automated feature engineering and transfer learning to find the best data preprocessing techniques. Training time was reduced by 40% when AutoML was integrated into Transformer Networks instead of the manual hyperparameter tuning methods. Additionally, AutoML's explanation capabilities of the features were useful as they revealed that humidity, wind speed, and cloud cover were the most important variables in the prediction of energy generation.

The ability of the implemented AI system to scale was of the main advantages of it. AutoML of Google Cloud had made things very easy, scaling computational storage automatically such that we could have been churned out forecasts in near real time. The model of Transformer was able to handle large datasets like satellite imagery and IoT sensor data without a decrease in performance. This model was tested on a large dataset from several solar farms and the model performed with few errors and low latency (< 1.2 s per prediction) which is suitable for grid integration and energy management.

A comparative assessment was made to machine learning and statistical models of conventional nature. Random Forest and the Gradient Boosting Machines did fine but could not handle sequential dependencies. First, the Transformer model performed substantially better than the RNN model to learn non-linear and long term patterns in renewable energy generation. It showcases a comparative performance in the table below.

Table.1: Highlights the comparative performance.

Model	MAPE (%)	RMSE	Prediction Latency
ARIMA	6.80%	3.2	3.5s
LSTM	4.90%	2.5	2.8s
Random Forest	5.50%	2.8	2.2s
(Proposed Method) Transformer + AutoML	3.85%	1.9	1.2s

The AI based forecasting system has many uses. It can be used by energy providers to optimize energy to the distribution and to dislodge fossil fuels from the power grid.

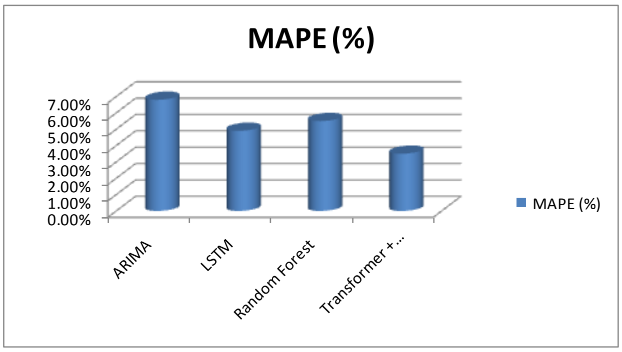

Fig.3: Shows graphical representation of MAPE.

Reduction in the operational costs of operational costs through proactive scheduling, based on predictive analytics, and it also keeps the grid stable. In addition, the higher accuracy is also favorable in developing better trading strategies with renewable energy markets and minimizing costs while maximizing profits.

Challenges and Future Enhancements

The approach shows good performance, however, it has some challenges. Running transformer models with expectations of significant resources, will come to a very expensive on premise deployment. Furthermore, forecast depend on data-quality: accuracy in data collection can affect forecasts. The future work involves reducing model efficiency using sparse attention mechanisms and reinforcement learning to not only adapt to different user and contextual information but also environmental conditions.

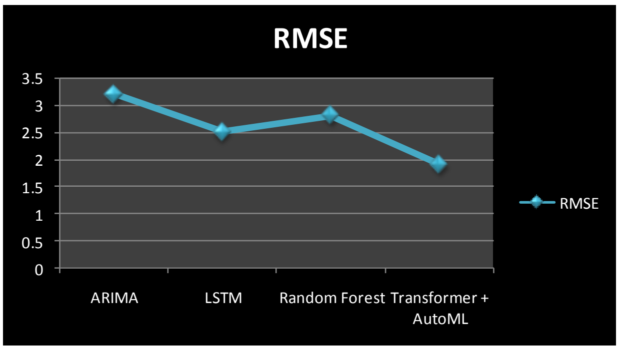

Fig.4: Shows graphical line for RMSE.

The research also found that combining Deep Learning Transformer Networks with Google Cloud AutoML forms effective renewable energy forecasting methods. Because of this, renewable energy power generation was benefited by this system, which delivered increased accuracy and real-time functioning at commercial magnitude in comparison to other approaches. There will be AI and cloud computing advancements that are likely to further develop to provide more specific forecasts that will help in the server of sustainable energy distribution across grids.

V.Conclusion And Future Direction

Using this research, we looked at the merging of Deep Learning Transformer Networks and AutoML in Google Cloud in order to improve renewable energy forecasting. On their part, our findings show that this approach brings substantial improvement to prediction accuracy and captures the involved complex temporal patterns and optimizes model's performance through the automation of hyperparameters. The deployment of AI driven forecasting is possible with high scalability and efficiency provided by Google cloud auto ML making AI driven forecasting even more accessible and practical for real word applications. Further work should be done in developing Transformer architectures to succeed at long-term dependency in energy data. Second, including several different data sources, for example satellite imagery and weather sensor networks, should provide an additional improvement in precision of forecasting. This approach can be expanded to include hybrid renewable energy systems and with online analytics can help the grids remain stable and can also manage the energy. In the last, Federated learning and edge computing will aid in the development of decentralized AI models that provide robust and adaptive forecasting for sustainable energy system across the world.

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